Unity's future roadmap

At Unite we had the chance to see some of the most interesting developments that Unity is bringing to their game engine. Here's a sneak peak.

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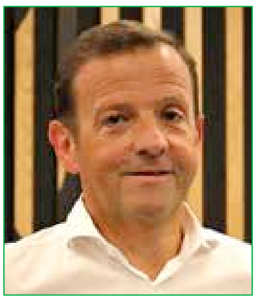
The deeper integration with Autodesk is not clear for someone who just makes games because it is always easy to import assets. Can you give us an idea about how this works better?

Ron Martin: Autodesk is a great partner for Unity. We have very close relations primarily through an FPX file format. When we import FPX into Unity, we can do a round trip with Maya which allows us to take all the components back to Autodesk and back in seamlessly. This allows people who are very familiar with Maya and skilled at doing animation to be able to go back and forth. It's a bilateral relation between the two different software.

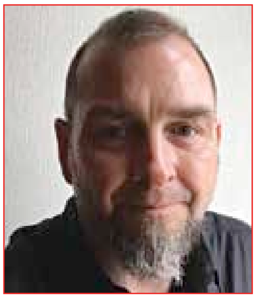


Hubert Larenaudie, President APAC & Global Head Distribution Platform, Unity Technologies

Ramesh: Everyone uses two monitors nowadays for artistic creations. So, if you have a Max or Maya in one window and Unity in another window, before round-tripping the process is basically six steps. The workflow becomes easy with the usage of round-tripping.

Will adoption be affected because smaller companies will need to invest in three different subscriptions.

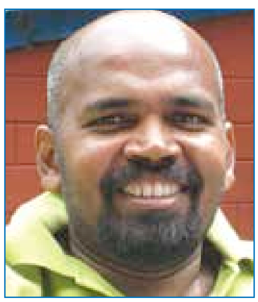
Ron Martin: We're finding that Unity builds an extensible platform for production which means you can make that decision. It does cost extra money. But Shotgun is very integrated and it comes with a lot of hooks for being able to take data in and out. You're right. Adding software to a production process can be expensive, especially for smaller shops. But they find a way to either make it work or they find ways of inventing their own.



Ron Martin, Evangelist BizDev – Film, Unity Technologies

One of the key points that were discussed was that the creators would be freed from render farms, but there's always some sort of pushback from the vendors and industries. So, what kind of challenges do you foresee when creators to make the transition?

Ron Martin: So, we see other render engines develop real-time technologies, that means, we think we're doing something right. But the integrated toolkits that are built-in to Unity allow the creatives to visualise their process. Integrated real-time into the toolkit means we all advance together. So, the outcome is that the artists are seeing their own skills develop and they get to spend more time making the art instead of waiting to see if the technology will let them down.



Anumukonda Ramesh, Unity Education and Centre Of Excellence Initiatives: Asia Pacific (APAC), Unity Technologies

But for workloads that require cinematic visuals, you still see those being done on Nvidia DGX systems and all.

Ron Martin: You know, we're seeing a shift there. The barrier to entry is much lower because of the strength and the power of the GPU, you don't need as big a machine on the GPU or CPU side, so you get longer life out of your existing hardware.

Ever since 2016, every single year since then has been touted as the year of VR. In your opinion, when will it actually be democratised to the point where HMDs are in theatres?

Hubert Larenaudie: I would say it (VR integration) is slower than what journalists and economists have predicted. With India as an example, we see a fast-growing, maybe niche, VR/AR usage. But another thing that's happening is that all the device manufacturers are supporting augmented reality. It's been slower than the people announce, but it is growing in term of business, it is growing by 50 per cent per year, which is absolutely not bad. The quality is not totally there yet, but a few weeks ago in Korea, I saw some huge improvements in terms of visual quality, feeling and experience. From manufacturing, defence, etc. We see this VR coming on strong even in filming.